DC UNIVERSE

105

BATMAN™

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PAGULAYAN
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AGES 13+

GOTHAM ISN'T BIG ENOUGH FOR THE THREE OF THEM!

Jorge Jimenez 2020

DC FUTURE STATE

JUSTICE LEAGUE

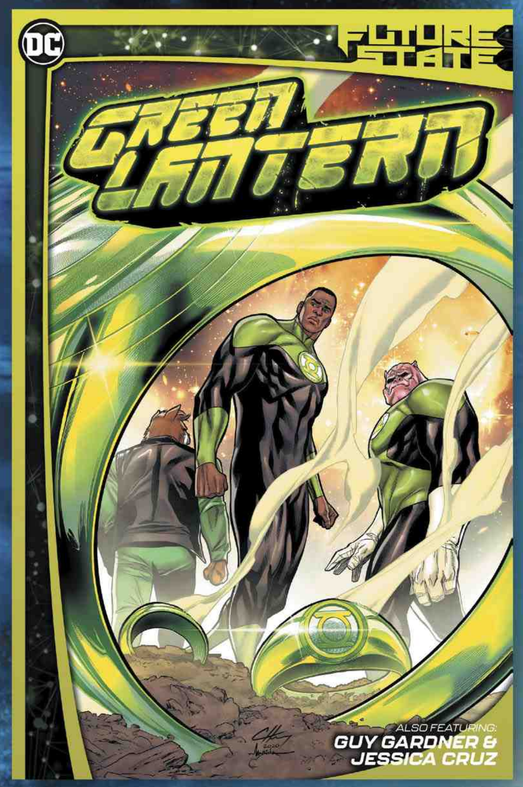


AN ALL-NEW TEAM FOR AN ALL-NEW ERA!

Written by **JOSHUA WILLIAMSON**
Art by **ROBSON ROCHA**

Includes a ***JUSTICE LEAGUE DARK*** bonus story

48 PAGES



JOHN STEWART MUST LEAD THE POWERLESS LANTERNS HOME!

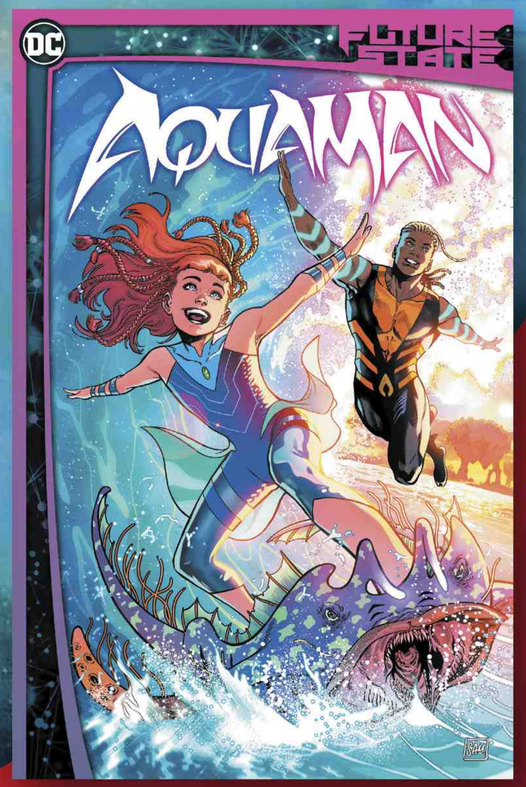
Written by
GEOFFREY THORNE
Art by
TOM RANEY

Includes a ***TALES OF THE GREEN LANTERN CORPS*** bonus story

48 PAGES

AN INTERGALACTIC ADVENTURE BEYOND THE SEVEN SEAS!

Written by
BRANDON THOMAS
Art by
DANIEL SAMPERE



DISCOVER THE DESTINY OF THE **DC UNIVERSE!**
JANUARY + FEBRUARY

#DCFutureState

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ARGENTINA.
YEARS AGO.

ASCENSOR ELEVATOR

YOU'RE GIVING UP, THEN.

GHOST STORIES PART 4

JAMES TYNION IV writer
CARLO PAGULAYAN & DANNY MIKI, ALVARO MARTINEZ & CHRISTIAN DUCE artists
DAVID BARON colorist

CLAYTON COWLES letterer JORGE JIMENEZ & TOMEU MOREY cover
FRANCESCO MATTINA variant cover JIMENEZ 1:25 variant cover DAVE WIELGOSZ assoc. editor
BEN ABERNATHY editor BATMAN created by BOB KANE with BILL FINGER

WHAT?

YOU'RE DONE WITH YOUR TRAINING. YOU'RE GOING BACK TO GOTHAM CITY.

IT'S TIME.

YOU'RE NOT READY.

WHAT?

YOU STILL DON'T UNDERSTAND, BRUCE. WHAT WE'RE DOING...WHAT WE'VE BUILT OURSELVES INTO THESE PAST YEARS...

I'M NOT INTERESTED IN HEARING THIS AGAIN FROM YOU.

WE'RE BOTH CRAZY.

I'M NOT THE PSYCHOPATH.

AND THAT'S WHY YOU'RE GOING TO DIE. PROBABLY IN THE FIRST SIX MONTHS OF YOUR WAR ON CRIME.

WHY IS THAT *YOUR* PROBLEM?

THE WORLD IS ***BROKEN,*** BRUCE. I THOUGHT YOU UNDERSTOOD THAT.

WE USED TO STAY UP LATE AT NIGHT AND TALK ABOUT JUST HOW BROKEN IT WAS, AND COME UP WITH IDEA AFTER IDEA FOR HOW TO MAKE IT BETTER.

NOT FOR GLORY OR PERSONAL GAIN, BUT FOR THE ***SAKE*** OF THE TASK ITSELF.

FOR THE SHEER ***ART*** OF IT, DAMMIT.

MAKING THE WORLD BETTER BECAUSE WE WERE THE ONLY ONES SMART ENOUGH TO GATHER THE SKILLS TO DO SO. TO TAKE EACH NEW CHALLENGE EAGERLY, AND LEARN WHAT WAS NECESSARY TO OVERCOME IT.

WHY DON'T YOU THINK I CAN DO THAT?

BECAUSE YOU ARE TRYING TO FULFILL THE PROMISE OF AN EIGHT-YEAR-OLD BOY! YOU'RE TRYING TO STOP A CRIME THAT'S ALREADY BEEN COMMITTED!

YOU CAN'T SAVE YOURSELF AS A BOY. NO MATTER HOW MUCH YOU TRAIN. NO MATTER HOW MANY SKILLS YOU'VE LEARNED.

I'M ***SICK*** OF YOU TELLING ME WHAT I CAN'T DO.

NO. ***LISTEN.***

YOU CAN'T SAVE EVERYONE. YOU CAN'T EVEN SAVE MOST PEOPLE.

IF EVERY LOSS CUTS AGAINST YOUR SOUL IT'LL WHITTLE YOU DOWN TO NOTHING.

TREAT CRIME-FIGHTING LIKE THE ART IT CAN BE.

LET GO OF YOUR PARENTS AND YOUR GUILT. LET GO OF GOTHAM. LET GO OF THE IDEA OF BRUCE WAYNE.

WE'LL START IN A SMALL CITY IN SOUTHEAST ASIA, AND SYSTEMATICALLY DISMANTLE ITS CRIMINAL UNDERWORLD. OUT ALL THE CORRUPT POLITICIANS. AND THEN WE'LL GO TO THE NEXT, AND THE NEXT.

WE'LL BUILD A HIGH-TECH BASE OF OPERATIONS THAT MOVES WITH US. WE'LL LIVE WELL OFF THE COFFERS OF THE GANGS WE DISMANTLE. WE'LL EXPAND FROM THERE.

IN TIME, MAYBE WE COULD EVEN TACKLE A CITY LIKE GOTHAM. NOT LIKE BOYS, BUT LIKE MEN AT THE PEAK OF OUR SKILLS.

NO.

YOU'RE A ***COWARD.*** YOU'RE TOO AFRAID OF BECOMING WHAT YOU ***KNOW*** YOU CAN BECOME.

I HAVE NO INTEREST IN NOT CARING ABOUT PEOPLE. I HAVE NO INTEREST IN GIVING UP THE MISSION I STARTED WHEN I WAS EIGHT YEARS OLD.

YOU'RE SICK. THERE'S A PART OF YOU THAT'S BROKEN AND YOU'RE ANGRY THAT IT'S NOT BROKEN IN ME.

TAKE THAT ***BACK.***

JUST LEAVE, KH--

NO!

YOU DON'T ***GET*** TO SAY MY NAME AGAIN. YOU DON'T ***GET*** TO SEE MY FACE.

FINE. ***GHOST-MAKER.***

IF YOU SET FOOT IN GOTHAM CITY, I'LL TREAT YOU LIKE ANY OTHER LAWBREAKER I FIND IN MY WAY.

I HAVE NO INTEREST IN THAT SEWER YOU CALL A HOME.

BUT FINE. THAT'S OUR DEAL.

I WON'T SET FOOT IN YOUR CITY, AND YOU WON'T SET FOOT IN ANY THAT I'VE SET UP CAMP IN.

GOOD.

NOW GET OUT OF MY ***WAY.***

I NEVER WANT TO SEE YOU AGAIN.

ARKHAM ASYLUM.
NOW.

BAO... DROP THE SWORD. TALK TO ME.

there's been too much talking already.

YOU'RE BEING PLAYED HERE. YOU'RE JUST A PAWN IN GHOST-MAKER'S PLANS.

IF YOU KILL HER, HE'S GOING TO COME HERE AND KILL YOU.

ALL TO TEACH ME A LESSON NOT TO CARE ABOUT PEOPLE.

you don't care about me.

YES, I DO.

I KNOW YOUR PAIN! I KNOW HOW MUCH YOU WANT TO MAKE THINGS RIGHT.

BUT THIS IS THE WRONG WAY TO DO IT.

maybe...

maybe i don't care.

HARLEY!

RRRRRAHHH!

SNAP

THANKS FOR THE SAVE, BATS.

GET OUT OF HERE. I'LL END THIS.

NO. I'M NOT GOING ANYWHERE.

why notz are you stupidz

PEOPLE THINK SO SOMETIMES, BUT I'M NOT. MY BRAIN WORKS A LITTLE SIDEWAYS, BUT IT'S A GOOD BRAIN.

I KNOW HOW YOU FEEL.

no you don't.

IT USED TO BE MY JOB TO KNOW HOW PEOPLE FEEL. I WAS A PSYCHIATRIST.

yeah, clearly you were really good at that.

SOMETHING YOU'RE GONNA LEARN IS THERE ARE LOTS OF DIFFERENT PATHS TO GROWING UP, AND MOST OF THEM #@$@ YOU UP PRETTY GOOD.

BUT I NEED YOU TO HEAR SOMETHING. AND THEN YOU CAN TRY TO KILL ME. OKAY?

if you're gonna talk, then *talk.*

I DON'T REMEMBER THAT NIGHT. I DON'T REMEMBER YOUR PARENTS. BUT THAT DOESN'T MATTER. I'VE DONE SO MANY BAD THINGS...

LOOK, IF BATMAN'S TELLING ME I WAS THERE, THEN I WAS THERE.

I'M SORRY YOUR PARENTS DIED.

I'M SORRY I HAD ANY KIND OF HAND IN IT.

I'M SORRY THAT GOT SO DEEP INTO YOUR HEAD IT MESSED YOU UP, AND NOW YOU'RE OUT THERE RUINING YOUR LIFE JUST TO TRY TO MAKE THINGS MAKE SENSE.

BUT YOU'VE GOT A WHOLE LIFE AHEAD OF YOU.

WHAT'S HIS NAME? BOW?

BAO.

OKAY. BAO.

clownhunter. i'm clownhunter.

BAO.

THERE ARE CONSEQUENCES TO DOING THE THINGS THAT JUST MAKE YOU FEEL STRONG.

I GOT... REALLY MESSED UP FOR A WHILE THERE. NOTHING IN MY LIFE FELT LIKE IT MADE ANY SENSE, AND THERE WAS THIS GUY TELLING ME EVERYTHING I WANTED TO HEAR.

HE MADE ME THINK HE WAS JUST A BROKEN PERSON, IN THE EXACT WAY THAT I THOUGHT I WAS A BROKEN PERSON. THAT HE HAD BUILT THIS SHELL TO PROTECT HIM.

"THAT HE'D PAINTED ON THIS GRIN, AND MADE EVERYONE AFRAID. AND THAT IT WAS ALL ***THEIR*** FAULT FOR MAKING US FEEL LIKE THAT.

"IT DIDN'T FEEL LIKE ANYBODY COULD HEAR ME, BUT ***HE*** HEARD ME. HE SAW ME. AND I #$@#@ LOVED THAT."

look, lady, if you think you're going to make me fall in love with the joker...

NO. THAT'S NOT IT.

I WANTED TO BE STRONG, AND HE WAS ABLE TO MANIPULATE ME AND CONTROL ME AND MAKE ME FEEL LOVED ENOUGH THAT I WAS WILLING TO HELP HIM DO REALLY TERRIBLE THINGS.

BECAUSE I WANTED TO FEEL STRONG TOO.

I WANTED TO BE THE ONE WITH ALL THE POWER. I WANTED TO BE THE ONE PEOPLE WERE AFRAID OF.

AND NOW...I'M GONNA BE DEALING WITH THE CONSEQUENCES OF THAT FOR MY ENTIRE LIFE. I'M ALWAYS GONNA BE HARLEY QUINN. AND I'M TRYING MY DAMNEDEST TO MAKE THE MOST OF IT.

I'M GONNA TRY TO SAVE AS MANY PEOPLE AS I TRIED TO HURT, BACK IN THE DAY. I WANT TO BE A BETTER VERSION OF ME.

BUT IF YOU WANT TO KILL ME, YOU CAN. I DESERVE IT.

HARLEY...

STAND BACK, BATS.

IT'S THE KID'S CHOICE.

...

raaaaah!

OH, PHEW.

BAO...

just leave me alone, okayz!

leave me alone!

THANK YOU, HARLEY.

YOU KNOW, I MEANT IT.

I DO KNOW.

ARE YOU GOING TO MAKE SURE THAT KID ENDS UP OKAY?

I'M GOING TO DO EVERYTHING IN MY POWER.

GOOD.

YOU SHOULD GET OUT OF HERE, TOO.

I NEED TO HAVE A FEW WORDS WITH AN OLD FRIEND.

I CAN CATCH THE BOY...YOU REALLY THINK I CAN'T?

OF COURSE YOU CAN. HE'S A TEENAGER WITH A BASEBALL BAT AND ALMOST NO COMBAT EXPERIENCE. HE'S NOT MUCH OF A TARGET.

IT WASN'T ***ABOUT*** PROVING ANYTHING.

I GENUINELY CARE ABOUT THAT BOY, AND I DON'T WANT HIM TO DESTROY HIS LIFE.

WHAT WAS THAT SUPPOSED TO PROVE?

DO YOU KNOW HOW MANY TIMES I COULD HAVE KILLED HARLEY OVER THE YEARS?

HOW EASY IT WOULD HAVE BEEN TO JUST ELIMINATE JOKER'S CLOSEST ASSOCIATES?

BUT THEN NOBODY LEARNS, NOBODY CHANGES. NOTHING IS BETTER IN THE END.

NOT EVERYONE CAN BE SAVED.

BUT MOST PEOPLE CAN. AND YOU USUALLY CAN'T TELL WHEN YOU'RE FACE-TO-FACE WITH THEM ON THE WORST DAY IN THEIR LIFE.

YOU'RE PROTECTIVE OF HIM BECAUSE HE LOST HIS PARENTS, LIKE YOU DID. YOU UNDERSTAND HIS MISSION. YOU EMPATHIZE WITH THAT CHILDISH DREAM.

I ALSO RECOGNIZE IT AS A MAN WHO HAS HELPED A LOT OF WAYWARD YOUNG PEOPLE FIND BETTER PATHS.

I'M NOT A TEENAGER ANYMORE. AND NEITHER ARE YOU. WE'RE GETTING OLDER. I'M NOT DONE TRYING TO SAVE THIS CITY. I DON'T THINK I EVER WILL BE.

CARING ABOUT PEOPLE HASN'T KILLED ME, YET.

YOU'VE COME CLOSER THAN MOST.

LIKE YOU HAVEN'T.

HEH.

I DON'T WANT TO FIGHT YOU. WE'VE BEEN FIGHTING TOO LONG.

FINE. WE DON'T HAVE TO FIGHT.

I'LL LEAVE GOTHAM IN THE MORNING. WE'LL STICK TO THE OLD ARRANGEMENT.

YOU KNOW, IT'S TOO BAD. I WAS HOPING YOU WERE GOING TO COME AT ME WITH ONE OF YOUR CARS. I'VE ALWAYS BEEN JEALOUS OF YOUR CARS.

I'M BUILDING A NEW ONE.

FLYING?

NO. ALL WHEELS ON THE GROUND. BUILT FOR SPEED AND MANEUVERING THE STREETS.

NOT A TANK THEN.

NOT A TANK.

I'LL BE WATCHING ON THE GHOST-NET.

YOU DON'T HAVE TO.

WHAT DO YOU MEAN?

DON'T LEAVE GOTHAM. STAY. HELP ME MAKE IT BETTER.

WHY?

BECAUSE I'M GETTING OLDER, AND THIS CITY IS GETTING YOUNGER. I DON'T HAVE THE RESOURCES I USED TO HAVE, OR THE ALLIES WITHIN LAW ENFORCEMENT AND CITY GOVERNMENT.

I COULD USE THE HELP.

I'M NOT GOING TO STOP TELLING YOU WHAT YOU'RE DOING WRONG.

GOOD. SINCE ALFRED PASSED, I DON'T HAVE ENOUGH OF THAT IN MY LIFE.

AND I'M NOT GOING TO WEAR A BAT ON MY CHEST.

I WOULDN'T ASK YOU TO.

MY ONLY RULE IS YOU DON'T KILL IN MY CITY.

YOU'RE SO LIMITED.

IT MAKES THE JOB ***MUCH*** HARDER. BUT I GUESS I UNDERSTAND IF YOU'RE NOT WILLING TO ***RISK*** FAILING.

AH, SO THAT'S HOW IT IS.

CAN YOU STAND THE CHALLENGE?

HEH. I GUESS I CAN.

"YOUR FAMILY IS OUT THERE. WAITING TO BEAT ME HALF TO DEATH AND SAVE YOU. I WAS LETTING THEM WATCH US. I THOUGHT THEY'D LEARN SOMETHING IF THEY SAW YOU LOSE."

"I KNOW. I GAVE THEM THE SIGNAL TO STAND BACK."

COME SAY HELLO.

ACTUALLY, BATMAN...I JUST GOT AN ALERT FROM YOUR FRIEND, ORACLE, JUST AS I LOWERED MY GHOST-NET BLOCKS ON HER COMPUTER SYSTEM.

THE CIRCUS OF THE STRANGE JUST HIJACKED THE GOTHAM SYMPHONY ORCHESTRA.

I BET I CAN GET TO THIS ORCHESTRA FASTER THAN YOU.

I'LL TAKE THAT BET.

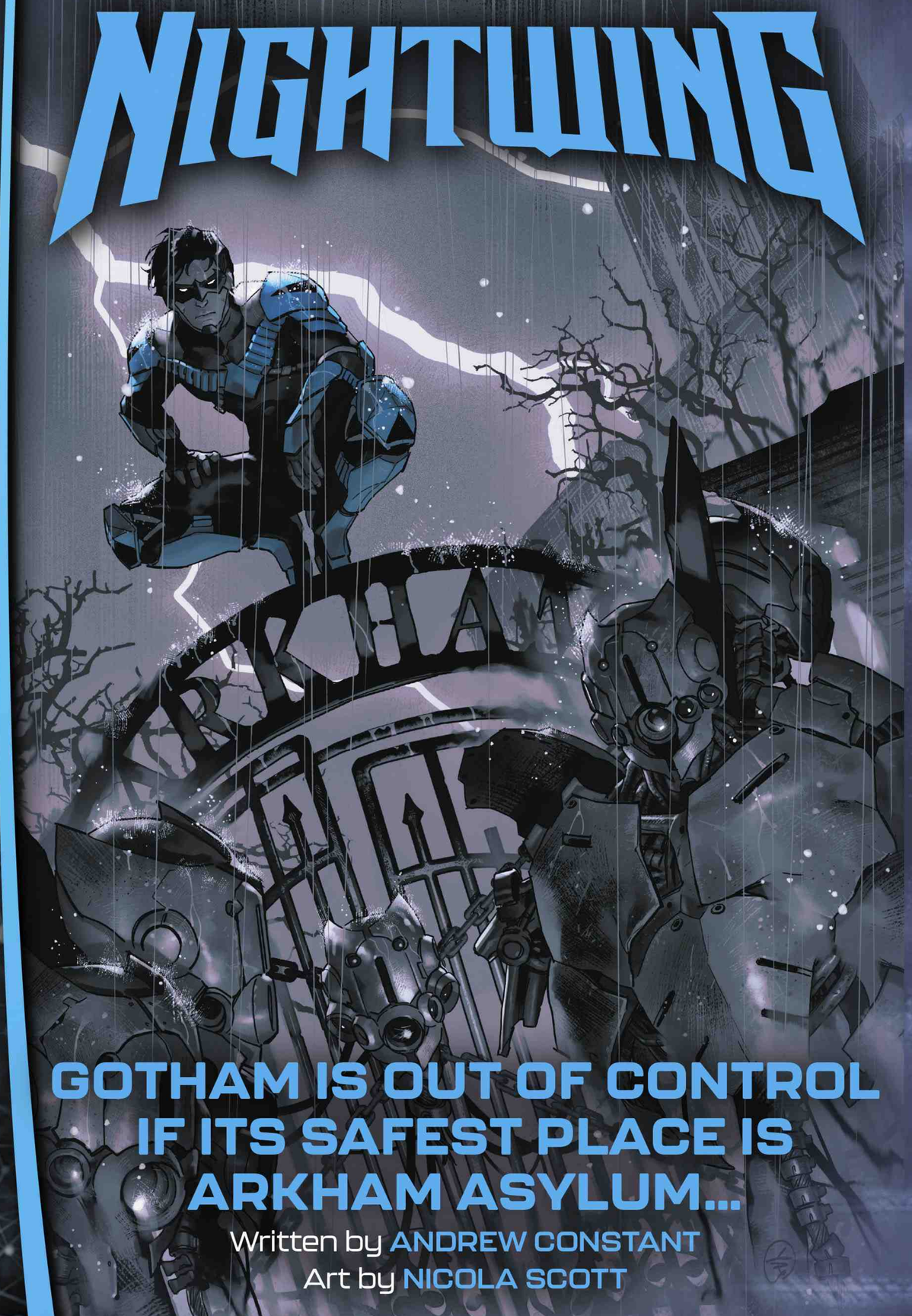
YOU KNOW, I'M RICHER THAN YOU ARE, NOW.

GOOD. THAT MEANS YOU'RE BUYING DINNER AFTER. I DON'T HAVE A BUTLER ANYMORE.

CLOWNHUNTER'S STORY CONTINUES IN **BATMAN ANNUAL!**
BATMAN AND GHOST-MAKER WILL RETURN IN **MARCH 2021!**
NEXT MONTH: **FUTURE STATE!**

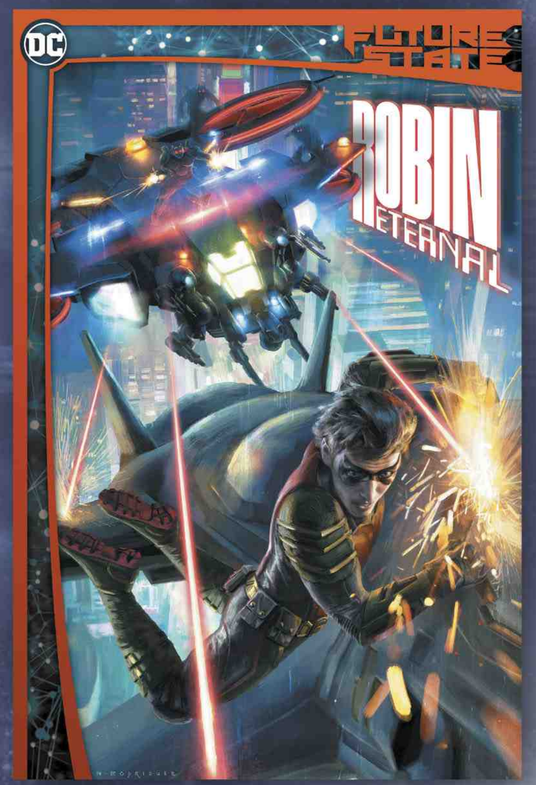
DC FUTURE STATE

NIGHTWING



GOTHAM IS OUT OF CONTROL IF ITS SAFEST PLACE IS ARKHAM ASYLUM...

Written by ANDREW CONSTANT
Art by NICOLA SCOTT

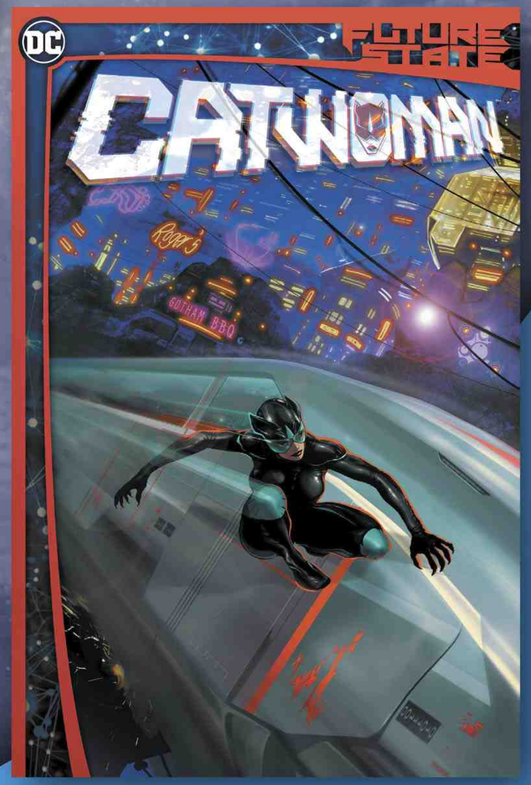


TO STOP THE MAGISTRATE FROM GAINING IMMORTAL LIFE, HE MUST RISK CERTAIN DEATH!

Written by
MEGHAN FITZMARTIN
Art by
EDDY BARROWS

EVEN HEROES CAN'T SAVE GOTHAM NOW. GOOD THING SHE'S NO HERO.

Written by
RAM V
Art by
OTTO SCHMIDT



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JANUARY + FEBRUARY

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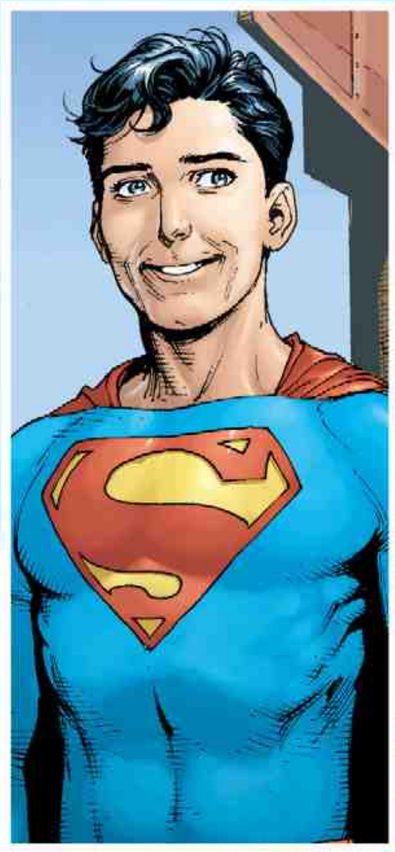
GENERATIONS SHATTERED

What started in *Detective Comics* #1027 and *Dark Nights: Death Metal* continues in the 80-page one-shot *Generations Shattered* #1, as an unlikely team of heroes gathers to confront an existential cosmic threat—with the cast plucked from different eras of both the DC Multiverse and DC's real-life publishing history.



BATMAN | DEBUT: 1939

This is the original, purple gloves-wearing Dark Knight, representing the foundational Golden Age of comics.



SUPERBOY | DEBUT: 1945

Straight from the 30th century, it's young Clark Kent during his time in the Legion of Super-Heroes.

SINESTRO | DEBUT: 1961

We meet Sinestro at his origin, as a member of the Green Lantern Corps.





KAMANDI | DEBUT: 1972

The Last Boy on Earth debuted in the `70s, but hails from a savage postapocalyptic future.



STARFIRE | DEBUT: 1980

Starfire joins from the character's earliest days as a main player in *The New Teen Titans.*



DR. LIGHT | DEBUT: 1985

A heroic counterpart to the villain of the same name, and Justice League and Doom Patrol alum.

BOOSTER GOLD
DEBUT: 1986

Born in the 25th century, he became a fan favorite as a member of Justice League International.



GENERATIONS SHATTERED #1
ON SALE IN JANUARY!

AND DON'T MISS THE FOLLOW-UP

GENERATIONS FORGED #1
ON SALE IN FEBRUARY!



STEEL
DEBUT: 1993

First put on his armor in one of *the* comics events of the 1990s, "The Death of Superman."

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